

Jonathan García Fuentes

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EDUCATION

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany

July 2026 (expected)

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) *Supervisors*: Prof. Tilman Brück, Prof. Harald Grethe, and Prof. Andrea Guariso

Visiting Scholar, Cornell College of Human Ecology – Prof. John Hoddinott

Fall 2025

Georg-August-Universität Göttingen, Germany

October 2022

Master's of Science in Development Economics (M.Sc.). *Specialization*: Quantitative Economics.

Università degli Studi di Torino, Italy

February 2019

Master's in Applied Labour Economics for Development (M.S.)

Universidad Centroamericana (UCA), Nicaragua

May 2013

Bachelor of Science in Applied Economics (B.Sc.). *Minor*: Economic & Territorial Development.

EMPLOYMENT

Zero Hunger Lab (IGZ & Humboldt University)

July 2023 – present

Research Fellow: Economic Development and Food Security Research Group - IGZ

- Impact Evaluation (cRCT): Testing Targeting Variants for Humanitarian Food Assistance in DRC. *Collaboration with WFP-Office of Evaluation (OEV) and WB's DIME*. [REPORT](#)
- Beneficiaries' preferences for food assistance. *Collaboration with WFP-OEV*.
- Horticulture Policy and Food Security (Systematic Review).

International Security and Development Center (ISDC)

November 2023 – present

Research Affiliate: Impact Evaluation (RCT): Retargeting Humanitarian Food Assistance in Lebanon: A Nation-Wide Experiment. Collaboration with *WFP-OEV* and *WFP-CO Lebanon*. [REPORT](#)

Collaboration for International Development Economics Research (Cornell University)

May 2025 – present

Research Fellow: STARS Program

United Nations World Institute for Development Economics Research (UNU-WIDER)

April – June 2025

Research (PhD) Fellow: Project, Optimizing Transfer Value in DRC: Household and Community Impact.

United Nations World Food Program (WFP)

October 2020 – July 2023

Regional Bureau for Southern Africa | Regional Targeting & Research Officer

June 2021 – June 2023

- Targeting and Assessment Advisor for **12 countries** (including DRC, Mozambique, Madagascar, Malawi, Zimbabwe, Lesotho, Tanzania, Angola), to reach **17 million** beneficiaries in the region.
- Led a multi-country impact evaluation (Rapid Rural Transformation) in Madagascar, Mozambique, and DRC.
- Co-coordinator of the Regional Urban Preparedness project (RUP, **€1 million**, financed by ECHO).
- Innovation focal, managing a **US\$100,000** innovation fund with a focus on Earth Observation and AI.

Cabo Delgado, Mozambique | Vulnerability-Based Targeting Coordinator

August – November 2021

- Designed and coordinated the first population registry and targeting system for **1.6 million** IDPs and host families.

Sudan | Profiling, Targeting & Studies Coordinator

October 2020 – June 2021

- Design and implement assessments and targeting systems for WFP's **6 million** people operation.

Leibniz Universität Hannover & German Institute for Economic Research (DIW)

June – October 2020

Research Assistant: RCT - "Financial Education, Mobile Money, and Small-scale Entrepreneurs in Uganda."

Centre for Modern Indian Studies (CeMIS)

January 2019 – September 2020

Research Assistant: RCTs, quasi-experiments, and descriptive studies.

January 2019 – September 2020

Field Coordinator: Impact evaluation of a new hospital. N=12,000 patient exit survey.

September - October 2019

United Nations World Food Program (WFP)

April 2019 – September 2018

Mozambique | RAM Officer

December 2016 - June 2017

- Designed and implemented a monitoring system for a 1 million beneficiary emergency operations and led WFP's contribution to the first National Nutrition Survey (**3,000 HH**) and IPC Acute Malnutrition.

Regional Bureau for Latin America | RAM Officer

April – December 2016

- Market assessments and price monitoring advisor for the region; Data manager post-earthquake food security assessment Ecuador.

Nicaragua | Research, Assessment, and Monitoring (RAM) Associate

April 2014 – September 2018

- Support monitoring, market and impact assessments, and price monitoring for WFP's operation in Nicaragua.

Junior Economist: advising the input-output matrix base 2012 (Nicaragua's Central Bank), tax reform 2012 (National Council of Private Enterprise), and social security reform 2013 (National Institute of Pensions and Social Security).

Research and Development Institute NITLAPAN, Research Assistant

September - November 2012

TECHO, Analysis & Data Coordinator "*Census of Slums in the Pacific of Nicaragua*." [LINK](#) January - November 2012

RESEARCH

PhD Dissertation

- Testing Targeting Variants for Emergency Transfers. Statistical- vs. Community-based Targeting in Eastern DRC. *Joint work with Andrea Guariso, Felipe Dunsh, Marcus Holmlund, Jonas Heirman, and Kristen McCollum*. [Draft](#).
- When Humanitarian Assistance Fades Out: Experimental Evidence from a Nation-Wide Program in Lebanon. *Joint work with Ghassan Baliki, Felipe Dunsh, and Andrea Guariso*. [Draft](#)
- Optimizing Transfer Value in DRC. *Joint work with Aysha Twose*
- Beneficiaries' Preferences for Humanitarian Food Assistance Design. Three Discrete Choice Experiments in DRC.

Peer-PhD Work

- The Impacts of a New General Hospital on Waiting Time and Out-of-Pocket Expenditure for Outpatient Care. [Draft](#)
- Predictors of patients' choice and pathways of access to hospitals under universal health coverage: a case study of the Nicaraguan capital. **BMC Health Services Research** 2021. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12913-021-07333-z>
- Socio-economic predictors of adolescent marriage and maternity in West and Central Africa between 1986 and 2017. **J Glob Health** 2021; <https://doi.org/10.7189/jogh.11.13002>
- Levels and trends of adolescent marriage and maternity in West and Central Africa, 1986-2017. **J Glob Health** 2021; <https://doi.org/10.7189/jogh.11.13001>
- The Gender Pay Gap: Triple penalty? Woman, mother, and informal. Evidence from Nicaragua. *Revista de Economía y Finanzas*, Vol. 7. *Central Bank of Nicaragua*. [PDF Spanish](#) [Original \(English\)](#) [Code](#) [Best paper 2020](#), [BCN](#)

FELLOWSHIPS, SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

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| ▪ Joachim Herz Add-on Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Economics. €12,500 | 2024-2026 |
| ▪ WFP's Innovation Award for developing a drought forecast model for Southern Africa. US\$100,000 | 2021 |
| ▪ Economy, Finance, and Development Award. 1 st place, research award. Nicaragua's Central Bank. US\$4,000 | 2020 |
| ▪ DAAD-EPOS Programme Scholarship for Graduate Studies in Development Economics. €35,000. | 2018 |
| ▪ MALED Scholarship for Graduate Studies in Labor Economics by ILO and University of Turin. €7,000. | 2017 |
| ▪ Academic Excellence Award, Universidad Centroamericana, Applied Economics. 2013. | 2013 |
| ▪ Young Researchers, Universidad Centroamericana - Nicaragua. 3 rd place. | 2012 |
| ▪ Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies in Applied Economics, 2009-2013. Universidad Centroamericana. | 2009 |
| ▪ Bronze medallist with Nicaragua's national basketball team (U15 and U17), Central American Championship. | 2007 |

TEACHING

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin - Germany July 2023 - present

- Teaching Assistant (Graduate): • Economics of Rural Development

Georg-August-Universität Göttingen - Germany

January 2019 – September 2020

- Teaching Assistant (Graduate): • Development Economics III • Poverty & inequality

Universidad Centroamericana (UCA) - Nicaragua

February 2010 – December 2013

- Lecturer (Undergraduate): • Macroeconomic Accounts • Business Economics.
- Teaching Assistant (Graduate): • Econometrics I and Statistical Inference. • Mathematics I, II and III.

CONFERENCES, LECTURES & INVITED TALKS

2025 WIDER Conference (UNU-WIDER); CSAE 2025 (Oxford University); LEADS (Bremen).

2024 Leibniz Research Network CrisEn (Berlin); German Economic Association (VfS).

Panelist: -Forgotten Conflicts, join with Prof. Martin Gassebner, and Prof. Anna Minasyan (U. of Göttingen); Food Security and Conflicts, with Johan Swinnen, Lukas Kornher, and Bettina Rudloff. IAMO Forum, (Halle).

2023 *Panelist*: Are we on track Zero Hunger? with Prof. Meike Wollni and Margherita Squarcina (U of Göttingen); *Invited lecture*: Poverty and food insecurity measurement and targeting (Technische Universität München)

2022-2019 *Panelist*: Evidence and evaluation in humanitarian contexts (SAMEA, Johannesburg); *Invited lecturer*: Targeting the ultra-poor; Measuring food insecurity (Technische Universität München); DAAD annual meeting (Universität Hamburg).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software & Programming

- Stats./GIS/Data Vis.: STATA, R, Ngene, Gi, ArcGIS, TABLEAU. • Survey: ODK, SurveyCTO • Text: LaTeX, M. Office.

Languages

- Native: Spanish • Fluent: English, Portuguese, and Italian. • Intermediate: German (B1) and French (B1).